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Pregnant woman held by ICE: ‘I need help’

Criticizes way she was treated before being rushed to hospital

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

She was 24 weeks pregnant when she was detained by immigration agents earlier in February, locked in a holding room in Burlington without beds, forced to sleep on a concrete bench, and unable to communicate with her family.

She began to experience abdominal pains, which by the third day had become so unbearable she was lying on the floor of the cell crowded with multiple other detained women and struggled to get the attention of the guards.

“I started banging on the door,” Djeniffer Ben-vinda Ribeiro Semedo, 22, said in an interview. “I was like, ‘I need help.’”

She was eventually rushed to a hospital in Boston with symptoms “nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, and decreased fetal movement,” a physician at Beth Israel Deaconess Medical Center testified, and all the while immigration agents were stationed outside her room.

Ribeiro Semedo, of Brockton, was eventually released on her own recognizance after her attorney filed a petition in federal court challenging her detention.

The attorney, Carl Hurvich, said that US Immigration and Custom Enforcement’s policy dictates the agency not “detain, arrest, or take into custody for an administrative violation of the immigration laws individuals known to be pregnant, postpartum, or breastfeeding.”

ICE, Page A6

Black actor sues ART over hair treatment

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

A Black actor filed a race discrimination lawsuit against the American Repertory Theater on Thursday, alleging she was permanently disfigured during rehearsals for a 2025 production at the Harvard University-based theater, effectively ending her stage career.

Nike Imoru, who performed as a member of the chorus in Kate Hamill’s adaptation of “The Odyssey,” alleges the theater violated its contractual and legal obligations — as well as its very public pledge to be an antiracist organization — when it allowed a backstage employee who was not working as a hairdresser to style her hair, causing “permanent hair loss and painful scalp damage” as well as “severe emotional distress, depression, and panic attacks,” according to the suit.

“There were contractual safeguards to prevent this kind of injury,” Imoru said in an interview. “Those safeguards weren’t followed, and as a result, I’m suffering permanent hair loss.”

ART did not respond to requests for comment on the case.

The lawsuit, filed in Middlesex Superior Court, is the latest in a series of legal challenges against ART.

ART, Page A6

Health care’s gains mask a sorry job market

LARRY EDELMAN
COMMENTARY

The Massachusetts job market has been treading water. Without hospitals and other health care providers, it would have drowned.

Local employers shed a total of 4,500 jobs in 2024 and 2025. That’s not a big number in a state with more than 3.7 million workers.

But if you stripped out gains at health care and social assistance employers, job losses would have exceeded 20,000 — or nearly 20 percent of the positions added in the two years before that.

In a rare divergence, hiring in Massachusetts has dried up in many sectors even as the economy expands.

The same disconnect occurred after the 2008–2009 financial crisis and the earlier dot-com bust. But those episodes followed a recession, with employers reluctant to boost payrolls despite rebounding consumer spending, government outlays, and business investment.

Today, the economy has been growing with little interruption since the fall of 2020. Yet employers have hunkered down for a host of reasons, including trade and regulatory policy uncertainty, the

The lack of hiring has helped push the state’s jobless rate to 4.8 percent in December from 4.1 percent a year earlier.

looming impact of AI on labor needs, high borrowing costs, and low consumer confidence.

Massachusetts was among the first states to experience this so-called jobless expansion — a dichotomy between weak employment and healthy growth the

country is now facing for the first time since at least World War II.

The US added an anemic 181,000 jobs last year. Without health care and social assistance roles (including social workers, counselors, and personal care aides), employment would have declined by more than a half-million jobs.

Massachusetts has long benefited from an enviable mix of high-paying and often interrelated jobs in health care delivery and medical research; higher education; professional and business services (a sector that includes law, engineering, technology consulting, and bio-

TRENDLINES, Page A10

PURE GOLD FOR THE US



JULIEN DE ROSA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Megan Keller (second from left) rejoiced after scoring the game-winning goal in overtime against Canada to give the Americans the gold medal in a 2-1 win on Thursday. Keller is a Boston College graduate and the captain of the Boston Fleet in the Professional Women’s Hockey League. **Olympics coverage, C1, 4, 5.**

Nonprofits’ liability limits challenged

High-profile cases put focus on longstanding Mass. shield

By Liz Kowalczyk and Elizabeth Koh
GLOBE STAFF



FOLLOW-UP

Across the country, patients grievously harmed in hospitals have reaped hefty, multimillion-dollar court verdicts.

In Connecticut, a jury awarded \$17 million to a 27-year-old woman after providers missed critical red flags that resulted in her daughter being stillborn.

A Rhode Island man won \$40 million because hospital staff cut his blood thinners, which worsened his condition and forced amputation of his right leg. In New York, juries have been especially generous, with some of the highest medical malpractice verdicts against hospitals in the nation.

But this isn’t the case in Massachusetts, where patients are far more limited in what they can recover. Here, a century-and-a-half-old court precedent — one of a few in the nation, and the most stringent —

severely limits liability against nonprofits such as hospitals, universities, and churches. State law currently caps medical malpractice awards at \$100,000, while other liability awards are limited to \$20,000.

The “charitable immunity” law has long faced criticism, public pushback, and attempts at reform, including from lawyers and abuse victims who say it allows powerful institutions to hide behind their corporate status, and shield themselves from atoning financially for

NONPROFITS, Page A10

The former prince Andrew was arrested and held for hours by British police on suspicion of misconduct in public office related to his links to Jeffrey Epstein. **A3.**

Governor Maura Healey is losing another Cabinet member, with Housing Secretary Edward M. Augustus Jr. stepping down. **B1.**

The Seaport District will be getting a 14-story, 438-room hotel near the Menino convention center. **B5.**

An arts commission stacked with President Trump’s allies approved his \$400 million ballroom, bypassing the normal review process. **A2.**

Skaters are increasingly making their marks with music, particularly when it hasn’t been used before. **G1.**



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Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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OBSERVANCES GO ON IN GAZA STRIP



ABDEL KAREEM HANA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Amid the rubble of destroyed buildings, Palestinians sat at a long table to share the fast-breaking meal as they marked Ramadan on Thursday in Khan Younis. Muslims refrain from eating or drinking from sunrise to sunset during the holy month.

In peace call, Trump keeps focus squarely on himself

New board’s first meeting long on praise

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Two of President Trump’s second-term fixations converged at the inaugural meeting of his Board of Peace on Thursday: his desire to be seen as a great diplomat on the international stage and his quest to physically reshape the nation’s capital in his own image.

The meeting took place at the Donald J. Trump Institute of Peace, a building formerly inhabited by the nonprofit United States Institute of Peace that the White House rebranded with the president’s name in December. (A legal battle for control of the building is still working its way through federal appeals court.)

In a 45-minute speech, the

president touted his diplomatic accomplishments settling “eight wars, and I think a ninth to come.” He also emphasized the importance of the newly formed international entity.

“I believe it’s the most consequential board — certainly in terms of power and in terms of prestige, there’s never been anything close because these are the greatest world leaders,” said Trump, who, according to a leaked draft of the board’s charter, will serve as chairman for life.

The formation of the Peace Board follows Trump’s frustration at being passed over for the Nobel Peace Prize, which he claimed he deserves for intervening in several high-profile international armed conflicts

TRUMP, Page A4